

D442

Basic Nursing Skills

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 74-year-old patient who is a retired mail carrier, admitted for dizziness, has a lying BP of 132/80 with HR 76. After 3 minutes standing, BP is 108/74 with HR 98. He asks when lunch arrives. How should the nurse read these results?

- A. Negative, because 108/74 is still a normal blood pressure.
- B. Positive only if the heart rate rises above 120.
- C. Positive for orthostatic hypotension, because systolic fell 24 mm Hg.
- D. Negative, because diastolic fell only 6 mm Hg.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient's lying BP is 140/88. Which standing reading after 3 minutes meets the criteria for orthostatic hypotension?

- A. 130/82
- B. 150/94
- C. Any standing reading lower than 140/88
- D. 118/84

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

During the 0900 medication pass, the nurse enters room 412, where a patient she has cared for three days in a row is watching the news. What should the nurse do before giving his medications?

- A. Confirm the room number and his last name.
- B. Ask him to state his full name and date of birth and compare them with his wristband and the MAR.
- C. Skip it, because she already knows him well.
- D. Ask, "Are you Mr. Garcia?"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

While changing a central line dressing for a patient who owns a bakery and has two teenage children, the nurse's sterile gloved hand brushes the outer edge of the sterile drape. What should the nurse do?

- A. Treat the glove as contaminated and replace it before continuing.
- B. Continue, because the drape itself is sterile.
- C. Continue if the touch lasted less than a second.
- D. Wipe the glove with alcohol and continue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A patient on continuous tube feeding at 60 mL/hr, whose wife visits every evening, needs a full linen change. Where should the head of the bed be during the feeding?

- A. At least 30 degrees only after the feeding is finished.
- B. The position does not matter at 60 mL/hr.
- C. At least 30 degrees; pause the feeding if the patient must lie flat.
- D. Flat, to make the linen change easier.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A patient with an indwelling urinary catheter, who is a former nurse and asks a lot of questions, is going to radiology in a wheelchair. Transport is waiting at the door. Where should the drainage bag go?

- A. Clamped for the trip.
- B. Hung on the wheelchair frame below bladder level, off the floor.
- C. Anywhere below the bladder, including the floor.
- D. On the patient's lap where it can be watched.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A 60-year-old grocery clerk, who had a stroke two months ago and now has left-leg weakness, is learning to walk with a cane. Her daughter bought the cane online. In which hand should she hold it?

- A. Right hand
- B. Either hand, as long as she is comfortable
- C. Left hand, moved forward before the right leg
- D. Left hand

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient correctly holds a cane in his left hand. Which leg is weaker?

- A. It cannot be known from cane position
- B. Both legs equally
- C. The left leg
- D. The right leg

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A patient with COPD, who smoked for 40 years and now repairs clocks as a hobby, is on 2 L/min by nasal cannula. His oxygen saturation is 90% and he is breathing comfortably. What should the nurse do?

- A. Switch to a nonrebreather mask.
- B. Turn off the oxygen, because he is comfortable.
- C. Increase to 6 L/min to reach 100%.
- D. Continue the current flow and keep monitoring.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Above about what flow rate does a nasal cannula stop adding useful oxygen and start drying the airway, so a mask is used instead?

- A. 6 L/min
- B. 15 L/min
- C. 10 L/min
- D. There is no limit; more flow always gives more oxygen.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A 79-year-old resident, who was a school principal and enjoys bingo, has a Braden score of 11 today. He is incontinent at night. What should the nurse conclude?

- A.** He is at low risk, because 11 is near the middle of the scale.
- B.** He is at high risk and needs a prevention plan, such as turning at least every 2 hours.
- C.** His score means he already has a stage 2 pressure injury.
- D.** He needs no plan until a wound appears.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which Braden Scale score shows the greatest risk of a pressure injury?

- A.** 15
- B.** 19
- C.** 9
- D.** 23

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A 74-year-old patient ~~who is a retired mail carrier~~, admitted for dizziness, has a lying BP of 132/80 with HR 76. After 3 minutes standing, BP is 108/74 with HR 98. ~~He asks when lunch arrives.~~ How should the nurse read these results?

Target word: positive or negative orthostatic test **Decides:** Systolic dropped 24 mm Hg (132 → 108).

A	Adjacent category	The test is about the change, not whether the standing value is in range.
B	Absolute language	Heart-rate change supports the finding but is not required.
C	Correct	A systolic drop of 20 or more is enough by itself.
D	Dropped element	Either criterion is enough; the systolic drop meets it.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A patient's lying BP is 140/88. Which standing reading after 3 minutes meets the criteria for orthostatic hypotension?

Target word: reverse: choose the qualifying reading **Decides:** Needs systolic drop ≥ 20 or diastolic drop ≥ 10 .

A	Confusion set	Systolic drops only 10; the 10-point threshold applies to diastolic, not systolic.
B	Inverted operation	Blood pressure rose instead of fell.
C	Absolute language	A small drop is normal; the thresholds must be met.
D	Correct	Systolic drops 22 mm Hg.

3. Answer B Concept 2

During the 0900 medication pass, the nurse enters room 412, where a patient ~~she has cared for three days in a row is watching the news.~~ What should the nurse do before giving his medications?

Target word: identification method **Decides:** Two patient-specific identifiers checked against the MAR/wristband.

A	Adjacent category	Room number is a location, not a patient identifier.
B	Correct	Two identifiers, stated by the patient, checked against records.
C	Camouflage	Familiarity does not replace the two-identifier check.
D	Confusion set	A yes/no question invites a confused patient to agree.

4. Answer A Concept 3

While changing a central line dressing for a patient ~~who owns a bakery and has two teenage children~~, the nurse's sterile gloved hand brushes the outer edge of the sterile drape. What should the nurse do?

Target word: is the glove still sterile **Decides:** The outer 1-inch border is not sterile.

A	Correct	Touching the 1-inch border contaminates the glove.
B	Dropped element	Drops the 1-inch border rule.
C	Absolute language	Any contact counts; duration does not matter.
D	Adjacent category	Alcohol does not make a glove sterile again.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A patient on continuous tube feeding at 60 mL/hr, ~~whose wife visits every evening,~~ needs a full linen change. Where should the head of the bed be during the feeding?

Target word: position during feeding **Decides:** Aspiration prevention needs the HOB at least 30 degrees.

A	Dropped element	Drops the need to stay upright during the feeding itself.
B	Camouflage	Uses the rate detail; aspiration risk exists at any rate.
C	Correct	Upright positioning prevents aspiration while formula is running.
D	Inverted operation	Flat positioning while feeding raises aspiration risk.

6. Answer B Concept 5

A patient with an indwelling urinary catheter, ~~who is a former nurse and asks a lot of questions,~~ is going to radiology in a wheelchair. ~~Transport is waiting at the door.~~ Where should the drainage bag go?

Target word: bag placement during transport **Decides:** Below bladder level, off the floor.

A	Adjacent category	Clamping without an order risks retention and is not routine.
B	Correct	Gravity drainage prevents backflow; off the floor prevents contamination.
C	Absolute language	The floor contaminates the bag.
D	Inverted operation	Above bladder level lets urine flow back.

7. Answer A Concept 6

A 60-year-old ~~grocery clerk,~~ who had a stroke two months ago and now has left-leg weakness, is learning to walk with a cane. ~~Her daughter bought the cane online.~~ In which hand should she hold it?

Target word: which hand **Decides:** Cane goes on the strong side.

A	Correct	The cane goes opposite the weak left leg, on the strong side.
B	Absolute language	Placement matters for stability.
C	Confusion set	Mixes up the side and the step pattern.
D	Inverted operation	Holding it on the weak side reverses the rule.

8. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

A patient correctly holds a cane in his left hand. Which leg is weaker?

Target word: reverse: from cane side to weak side **Decides:** The cane is on the strong side.

A	Absolute language	Correct cane use shows the strong side.
B	Dropped element	A single cane is used for one-sided weakness.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the rule.
D	Correct	Cane in the left hand means the left side is strong.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A patient with COPD, ~~who smoked for 40 years and now repairs clocks as a hobby~~, is on 2 L/min by nasal cannula. His oxygen saturation is 90% and he is breathing comfortably. What should the nurse do?

Target word: action at target saturation **Decides:** 90% is within the 88-92% COPD target.

A	Adjacent category	For severe hypoxia, not a stable patient on target.
B	Inverted operation	Removing therapy that keeps him on target reverses the need.
C	Absolute language	Pushing to 100% can blunt breathing drive in CO2 retainers.
D	Correct	90% is on target for a patient with chronic CO2 retention.

10. Answer A Concept 7 • transfer

Above about what flow rate does a nasal cannula stop adding useful oxygen and start drying the airway, so a mask is used instead?

Target word: cannula upper limit **Decides:** Cannula range is about 1-6 L/min.

A	Correct	Standard nasal cannula tops out around 6 L/min.
B	Confusion set	The usual nonrebreather mask rate.
C	Adjacent category	The upper range of a simple face mask.
D	Absolute language	Above 6 L/min a cannula adds little and irritates the nose.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A 79-year-old resident, ~~who was a school principal and enjoys bingo~~, has a Braden score of 11 today. He is incontinent at night. What should the nurse conclude?

Target word: meaning of Braden 11 **Decides:** Low Braden score = high risk.

A	Inverted operation	Lower scores mean higher risk.
B	Correct	Scores of about 10-12 mean high risk.
C	Adjacent category	Braden predicts risk; it does not stage wounds.
D	Dropped element	The score exists to prevent injury before it forms.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

Which Braden Scale score shows the greatest risk of a pressure injury?

Target word: reverse: lowest score **Decides:** Lower score = higher risk.

A	Confusion set	Mild risk, not the greatest here.
B	Adjacent category	Above 18 is generally not at risk.
C	Correct	The lowest score here shows the greatest risk.
D	Inverted operation	The top score means the lowest risk.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Orthostatic vital signs	Orthostatic hypotension is a systolic drop of 20 mm Hg or more, or a diastolic drop of 10 or more, within 3 minutes of standing.	Requiring both numbers to drop, or judging only whether the standing BP looks normal.	Lying and standing blood pressures listed side by side.
2	Patient identification	Use two identifiers (such as full name and date of birth) and compare them with the MAR or wristband before every medication; never use room or bed number.	Relying on the room number or a yes/no question like "Are you Mr. Lee?"	A medication pass and a patient the nurse "already knows."
3	Sterile field	The outer 1-inch border and anything below waist level or out of sight are not sterile; if in doubt, it is contaminated.	Thinking a brief touch or a sterile-looking border is still safe.	A sterile glove or item touching the edge, the waist, or an unseen surface.
4	Enteral feeding safety	Keep the head of the bed at least 30 degrees during tube feeding and for about an hour after to prevent aspiration.	Laying the patient flat for care while the feeding keeps running.	A tube feeding plus repositioning or bathing.
5	Indwelling urinary catheter care	Keep the drainage bag below bladder level and off the floor, with tubing free of kinks, to prevent backflow and infection.	Placing the bag on the lap or bed during moves, or clamping it without an order.	A catheterized patient being moved or transported.
6	Cane use	Hold the cane on the strong side and move it forward with the weak leg.	Holding the cane on the weak side to "support" that leg.	One leg or side is weaker and the question asks about the cane.
7	Oxygen delivery	Nasal cannula runs about 1–6 L/min; higher needs call for a mask; patients with chronic CO ₂ retention (COPD) often target 88–92%.	Pushing every patient to 100% or turning a cannula above 6 L/min.	A cannula flow rate, a COPD patient, or a saturation goal.
8	Pressure injury risk	The Braden Scale runs 6–23; lower scores mean higher risk, and 18 or below signals risk that needs prevention such as turning every 2 hours.	Reading a higher Braden score as higher risk.	A Braden score and a question about risk or next action.

Course scope (public description): Basic Nursing Skills will introduce foundational principles of nursing process and the clinical judgement model, health assessment techniques, and communication skills needed to care for diverse adult patients across the lifespan. Skills will focus on the concepts of vital signs, medication administration, infection control, nutrition, elimination, mobility, oxygenation, and skin integrity. Students are required to be successful on lab assessments to progress to Adult Health1 clinical. Co-requisites: D443 and D444